

Business English

An 8-week, 16-class workplace-communication course for adults at B1 or above who use English at work, are looking for work, or are rebuilding a professional career in English. Twice a week for 90 minutes, you practice the real situations of working life: emails and messages, phone and video calls, meetings, networking, feedback, presentations, negotiations, pitches, reports, CVs and interviews. Between classes, the free online lessons (with audio) are your homework.

LEVEL	DURATION	EACH CLASS	CONTENT
B1+ · working adults	8 weeks · 16 classes	90 minutes · 2 × week	4 modules · 12 lessons

CLASS SCHEDULE

Two classes a week, 90 minutes each. Twelve classes each teach **one lesson** from the online course, and four are assessment classes: a **needs analysis** in Class 1, a **Midpoint Performance Check** in Class 8, and a two-part **Final Assessment** in Classes 15 and 16. Every lesson runs as a **workplace-skills workshop**: a real model, the key phrases, controlled practice, a role-play or writing task, and feedback on register, tone, and clarity. ✓ = the can-do goal for that class.

WEEK 1		First Impressions & Register
Module 1: orientation, a needs analysis, and the register that shapes every message.		
C1	NEEDS	Orientation + Needs Analysis course map · your workplace needs and goals · a reply-email writing sample · a 3-minute speaking sample (introductions + a phone message) · the course rubric ✓ I know my starting point and my three workplace goals.
C2	1.1	Business Register, Tone & First Impressions formal, neutral and friendly-professional · softening and tone · greetings and introductions · your professional self-introduction ✓ I can choose the right register and introduce myself professionally.

WEEK 2**Emails & Calls**

Module 1: the two channels you use every working day.

C3**1.2****Professional Emails & Messaging**

one email, one purpose · subject lines, greetings and sign-offs · requests, replies, follow-ups and bad news · CC, BCC, reply-all and chat etiquette

✓ **I can write a clear, correctly pitched business email.**

C4**1.3****Telephoning & Virtual Calls**

answering, stating your purpose, connecting and ending · taking and leaving messages · spelling, numbers and dates · video-call etiquette and tech problems

✓ **I can handle a business call and take an accurate message.**

WEEK 3**Meetings & Rapport**

Module 2: taking part in meetings, then building working relationships.

C5**2.1****Meetings — Participating & Chairing**

opinions, agreeing and disagreeing politely · interrupting and turn-taking · chairing from an agenda · minutes and action points

✓ **I can take part in a meeting and chair a short one.**

C6**2.2****Small Talk, Networking & Building Rapport**

openers and follow-up questions · safe and risky topics · joining and leaving conversations · the follow-up message

✓ **I can start, sustain and end a networking conversation.**

WEEK 4**Tact & the Midpoint Check**

Module 2: firm but diplomatic language, then a check on the first half.

C7**2.3****Diplomatic & Assertive Communication**

pushing back diplomatically · constructive feedback · saying no without damage · handling complaints and tension

✓ **I can disagree, give feedback and decline requests with tact.**

C8**CHECK****Midpoint Performance Check**

a timed email + register rewrite (~35 min) · pair simulations: a phone call and a short meeting · marked with the course rubric, returned in Class 9

✓ **I know my strengths and my targets for the second half.**

WEEK 5**Presenting & Negotiating**

Module 3: speaking in front of a room, then reaching agreement.

C9

3.1

Presentations — Structure & Delivery

opens with Midpoint results · a strong opening and close · signposting · describing charts and trends · handling Q&A

✓ I can deliver a clear, well-signposted short presentation.

C10

3.2

Negotiations — Language & Strategy

the stages of a negotiation · proposals and counter-proposals · *If you..., we'll...* · trading concessions · deadlock and closing

✓ I can negotiate a win-win deal with conditional language.

WEEK 6**Persuading & Documents**

Modules 3–4: pitching an idea, then writing the documents that decide it.

C11

3.3

Pitching, Persuasion & Handling Objections

problem → solution → benefit → evidence → call to action · benefits, not features · credibility signals · handling objections calmly

✓ I can pitch an idea in 90 seconds and answer objections.

C12

4.1

Reports, Proposals & Business Documents

report vs proposal structure · the executive summary · formal, objective register · recommendations that get approved

✓ I can write a short report or proposal with an executive summary.

WEEK 7**Career & the Capstone**

Module 4: your next job move, then the integrated review project.

C13

4.2

CVs, Cover Letters & Job Interviews

results-focused CV bullets · a targeted cover letter · common and behavioral questions · the STAR method · closing the interview

✓ I can present my experience with confidence on paper and in person.

C14

4.3

Review Project — The Complete Business Communicator

one connected business scenario · adapting register, tone and channel · cross-cultural awareness · planning and rehearsing your final presentation

✓ I can combine the whole course in one realistic scenario.

WEEK 8**Final Assessment & Celebration**

Whole course: a two-part final assessment, a debrief, and a celebration.

C15**FINAL****Final Assessment, Part A**

timed writing (~60 min): a short proposal section + a cover letter or formal email · pair negotiation simulations

✓ **I can write and negotiate under realistic time pressure.**

C16**FINAL****Final Assessment, Part B + Celebration**

capstone presentations or pitches with Q&A · short mock job interviews · debrief · certificates

✓ **I can present, persuade and interview with confidence.** 🎉

EVERY CLASS, THE SAME SHAPE

A steady routine makes it easy to take risks in role-plays. Timings flex from lesson to lesson; the writing lessons give the writing task more time.

0:00**Warmer & review of the last class**

A quick task that recycles last class's phrases, or links today's topic to your own work

0:10**Model & key language**

A real email, call, meeting, or pitch · notice the phrases, register, and tone

0:25**Controlled practice**

Workbook tasks in pairs · drilling for stress and polite intonation

0:45

Break (5 min)

0:50**Role-play or writing task**

A realistic workplace simulation with role cards · or a timed document

1:10**Feedback**

Peer and teacher feedback against the course rubric · delayed error correction · "I can..." checklist

1:25**Homework set-up**

The online lesson with 🎧 audio + one workbook page

COURSE DETAILS

● Prerequisites

- ◆ **CEFR B1 or above recommended.** You can handle everyday conversations, follow the main points of clear speech, and write a simple connected paragraph.
- ◆ New to our program? Ask your teacher for the program's **placement test** first. Learners placing at B1 to C2 are ready for this course; mixed levels work well, because every task has support and stretch options.
- ◆ Placed at A2 or below? Build your general English first with Independent English (B1), then join Business English. Want more grammar alongside it? Confident English (B2) pairs well with this course.
- ◆ No job needed. Every task that asks about your work has a **role-card option**: a fictional job and company, so you never have to share personal details.

● What's Provided

- ◆ A **Student Workbook** for all 12 lessons, with model emails, dialogues, phrase banks, role-plays, and self-checks (the learner keeps it)
- ◆ A **welcome handout** (how the classes run, the course rubric in plain words, QR codes to the online lessons) and a one-page **performance tracker**
- ◆ For the teacher: a **Teacher's Guide** (a 90-minute plan for every class), slides, role-play cards, listening scripts, games, the needs analysis, the midpoint check, the final assessment, and answer keys
- ◆ Free access to the companion online course: Business English, with  audio
- ◆ A free learning-tools page that shows how to translate lessons into any language

■ Assessment

- ◆ **Every class:** role-plays and writing tasks with feedback and an “I can...” checklist, with no grades
- ◆ **Class 1 • Needs analysis:** a workplace-needs survey, a short reply email, and a 3-minute speaking sample
- ◆ **Class 8 • Midpoint Performance Check:** a timed email and register rewrite, plus a phone call and a short meeting simulation
- ◆ **Classes 15–16 • Final Assessment:** timed writing (a proposal section and a letter or email), a negotiation, a presentation or pitch with Q&A, and a short mock interview
- ◆ One simple rubric throughout: **Task & Purpose • Register & Tone • Language Range & Accuracy • Organization & Delivery**, each scored 1–5
- ◆ Scores are private and used to set your own targets. Everyone who completes the course receives a certificate

■ Homework & the Online Course

- ◆ After each class, do the matching **online lesson** at home: about **45–65 minutes**, with  Listen buttons for model sentences
- ◆ Plus one **workbook page**, and one real-world try each week: send the email, make the call, use the phrase at work
- ◆ Missed a class? The online lesson covers the same language, so you can catch up. Missed an assessment? Ask your teacher about a make-up slot
- ◆ The online lessons and the classroom materials both use American English. British spellings (*behaviour, organise*) are also correct in international business — just stay consistent in one document

What You'll Be Able to Do

By the end of the course, learners can handle the core communication tasks of professional life in English, clearly and with the right tone:

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|---|--|
| ✓ Choose the right register and tone for any audience, and make a strong first impression | ✓ Write clear, well-structured emails and messages for requests, updates, and bad news |
| ✓ Handle phone and video calls, and take accurate messages | ✓ Take an active part in meetings, and chair a short one with clear action points |
| ✓ Start, sustain, and end small talk, and follow up after networking | ✓ Disagree, give feedback, and say no diplomatically but firmly |
| ✓ Deliver a structured, well-signposted presentation and handle questions | ✓ Negotiate with conditional language and pitch an idea persuasively |
| ✓ Write a short report or proposal with an executive summary and clear recommendations | ✓ Present your experience in a CV, a cover letter, and a STAR-structured interview |

Companion course, free online: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum-business · Free translation & learning tools: rays-esl.netlify.app/curriculum/learning-tools.html · More general English first: B1 · B2

All companies, people, and figures in the course materials are fictional.

Ray de la Paz

v1.0 · 8 weeks · 16 classes · 24 instructional hours

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